SSC CGL 2019 Tier-I question paper with answers

7 March 2020 · Shift 1

49 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 51 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20200710213341/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Final_Answer_key%20cgle19t1.pdf

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1

Which of the following rivers forms the Dhuandhar waterfall near Jabalpur?

(A) Luni
(B) Tungabhadra
(C) Tapi
(D) Narmada

Q.2

Pradhan Mantri Jeevan Jyoti Bima Yojana offers a protection term insurance cover of _____ to the insurer.

(A) ₹2 Lakh
(B) ₹5 Lakh
(C) ₹8 Lakh
(D) ₹4 Lakh

Q.3

What does 'T' stand for in ATM?

(A) Transaction
(B) Teller
(C) Transfer
(D) Trunk

Q.4

Which of the following pairs is CORRECT with reference to mountain passes?

(A) Bomdila - Himachal Pradesh
(B) Nathula - Arunachal Pradesh
(C) Lipulekh - Uttarakhand
(D) Rohtang - Sikkim

Q.5

The scientific study of a cell is called:

(A) physiology
(B) histology
(C) cytology
(D) taxonomy

Q.6

Pravasi Bharatiya Divas is celebrated on:

(A) 2nd January
(B) 9th January
(C) 1st January
(D) 8th January

Q.7

Which of the following states does NOT share its boundary with Bangladesh?

(A) Assam
(B) Meghalaya
(C) Manipur
(D) Tripura

Q.8
For which game has the Father of Leander Paes been a member of the Indian National Team?

(A) Badminton
(B) Basketball
(C) Hockey
(D) Tennis

Q.9
Where is the Dharmraja Ratha monument located?

(A) Kanchipuram
(B) Mahabalipuram
(C) Suchindram
(D) Khajuraho

Q.10
Which among the following is a cation?

(A) Fluoride
(B) Chloride
(C) Iodide
(D) Ammonium

Q.11
In December 2019, the Rohtang passageway in Himachal Pradesh was renamed as:

(A) Atal Tunnel
(B) Bose Tunnel
(C) Swaraj Tunnel
(D) Mukherjee Tunnel

Q.12
Select the correct pair of dance form and its state.

(A) Thang Ta – Bihar
(B) Dalkhai – Karnataka
(C) Padayani – Kerala
(D) Kalbelia – Himachal Pradesh

Q.13
The Council of Ministers during the time of Shivaji Maharaj was known as:

(A) Agraharam
(B) Ashta Pradhan
(C) Ashta Diggajas
(D) Navaratnas

Q.14
With reference to the Vedangas, which of the following terms denotes 'Ritual'?

(A) Vyakarana
(B) Chanda
(C) Shiksha
(D) Kalpa

Q.15
The power of a lens is –2.0 D. Here 'D' stands for:

(A) dilation
(B) degree
(C) distance
(D) dioptre

Q.16
The Indian National Congress session of September 1920 was held at _____.

(A) Madras
(B) Calcutta
(C) Lucknow
(D) Nagpur

Q.17
Who is the author of the book 'Wise and Otherwise: A Salute to Life'?

(A) Zoya Hasan
(B) Kiran Desai
(C) Amrita Pritam
(D) Sudha Murthy

Q.18
Which of the following monasteries is located in Sikkim?

(A) Tabo
(B) Hemis
(C) Kye
(D) Rumtek

Q.19
Which among the following has its refractive index closest to that of crown glass?

(A) Canada balsam
(B) Ruby
(C) Sapphire
(D) Diamond

Q.20
Which of the following Articles of the Constitution of India guarantees the Right to Freedom of Religion?

(A) Articles 23-24
(B) Articles 25-28
(C) Articles 19-22
(D) Articles 14-18

Q.21
In which year was the first amendment to the Constitution of India made?

(A) 1953
(B) 1952
(C) 1950
(D) 1951

Q.22
The Pritzker prize is an international award given to recognise contribution in the field of _____.

(A) architecture
(B) mathematics
(C) literature
(D) medicine

Q.23
Which Indian male cricketer won the BCCI CK Nayudu Lifetime Achievement Award for the year 2019?

(A) Sachin Tendulkar
(B) K Srikanth
(C) Rahul Dravid
(D) Sunil Gavaskar

Q.24
Who was appointed as brand ambassador of Visa - the payment technology company in 2019?

(A) P.V. Sindhu
(B) PT Usha
(C) Sania Mirza
(D) Dutee Chand

Q.25
Which among the following is NOT an insulator?

(A) Mercury
(B) Ebonite
(C) Glass
(D) Dry Paper

English Comprehension 24 questions

Q.1
Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Already
(B) Accross
(C) Awful
(D) Alien

Q.2
Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Look down upon

(A) To be full of guilt
(B) To consider someone inferior
(C) To look for something underground
(D) To look down from a height

Q.3

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Sacred

(A) Valued
(B) Precious
(C) Holy
(D) Scarce

Q.4

Select the option that can be used as a one word substitute for the given group of words. A game in which neither party wins

(A) Draw
(B) Flop
(C) Quit
(D) Equal

Q.5

Select the correct passive form of the given sentence. The children sang the National Anthem with great enthusiasm.

(A) The National Anthem was being sung with great enthusiasm by the children.
(B) The National Anthem was sung with great enthusiasm by the children.
(C) The National Anthem is sung with great enthusiasm by the children.
(D) The National Anthem has been sung with great enthusiasm by the children.

Q.6

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Native

(A) Rural
(B) Rustic
(C) Urban
(D) Foreign

Q.7

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Advertising is the promotion of goods and services. It provides an (1)_____ to the manufacturing companies to sell their (2)_____ better than their competitors. Every time we switch (3)_____ the television we find some product or the other (4)_____ pushed towards us. It cannot be denied that the (5)_____ behind commercial advertising is to increase sales and earn more profit.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number (1).

(A) excuse
(B) opportunity
(C) occasion
(D) event

Q.8

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Advertising is the promotion of goods and services. It provides an (1)_____ to the manufacturing companies to sell their (2)_____ better than their competitors. Every time we switch (3)_____ the television we find some product or the other (4)_____ pushed towards us. It cannot be denied that the (5)_____ behind commercial advertising is to increase sales and earn more profit.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number (2).

(A) products
(B) compounds
(C) outcome
(D) creation

Q.9

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Advertising is the promotion of goods and services. It provides an (1)_____ to the manufacturing companies to sell their (2)_____ better than their competitors. Every time we switch (3)_____ the television we find some product or the other (4)_____ pushed towards us. It cannot be denied that the (5)_____ behind commercial advertising is to increase sales and earn more profit.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number (3).

(A) at
(B) on
(C) off
(D) in

Q.10

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Advertising is the promotion of goods and services. It provides an (1)_____ to the manufacturing companies to sell their (2)_____ better than their competitors. Every time we switch (3)_____ the television we find some product or the other (4)_____ pushed towards us. It cannot be denied that the (5)_____ behind commercial advertising is to increase sales and earn more profit.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number (4).

(A) to be
(B) been
(C) being
(D) be

Q.11

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Advertising is the promotion of goods and services. It provides an (1)_____ to the manufacturing companies to sell their (2)_____ better than their competitors. Every time we switch (3)_____ the television we find some product or the other (4)_____ pushed towards us. It cannot be denied that the (5)_____ behind commercial advertising is to increase sales and earn more profit.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number (5).

(A) motive
(B) emotion
(C) feeling
(D) influence

Q.12

Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence. The traveller said to a passerby, "Can you help me find my way, please?''

(A) The traveller asked the passerby could you kindly help me find my way?
(B) The traveller asked the passerby that he can kindly help him find his way.
(C) The traveller asked the passerby if he could kindly help him find his way.
(D) The traveller requested to the passerby if he can help him find his way.

Q.13

Identify the segment in the sentence which contains the grammatical error. If there is no error, select 'No error'
He married with a rich heiress last year.

(A) with a rich heiress
(B) He married
(C) No error
(D) last year

Q.14

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Weary

(A) Restless
(B) Exhausted
(C) Touchy
(D) Lively

Q.15

Identify the segment in the sentence which contains the grammatical error. If there is no error, select 'No error' The famous author and actor are being honoured at a function today

(A) at a function today
(B) are being honoured
(C) The famous author and actor
(D) No error

Q.16

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Repulsive

(A) Hideous
(B) Brilliant
(C) Attractive
(D) Revolting

Q.17

Fill in the blank with the most appropriate word. She was loved by her employees for her _____.

(A) benevolence
(B) malevolence
(C) condolence
(D) insolence

Q.18

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Keep abreast of

(A) Keep up the good work
(B) Keep ahead of
(C) Keep a watch on
(D) Keep oneself updated

Q.19

Fill in the blank with the most appropriate word. The minister gave an _____ that strict action would be taken against the culprits.

(A) assurance
(B) insurance
(C) ambition
(D) admission

Q.20

Given below are four jumbled sentences. Out of the given options pick the one that gives their correct order. A. When a calf is born under water, the mother must get it to the surface before it drowns. B. The young ones remain with their parents for up to fifteen years or more. C. Often another whale assists the mother nudging the baby gently and encouraging it to swim. D. Whales have highly developed maternal instincts.

(A) CBDA
(B) BCAD
(C) DACB
(D) DBCA

Q.21

Select the option that can be used as a one word substitute for the given group of words That which cannot be satisfied

(A) Inapt
(B) Insatiable
(C) Ingenuous
(D) Insane

Q.23

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select No improvement. Scarcely had the passengers boarded the plane “when the captain welcomed them.”

(A) than the captain welcomes them
(B) that the captain welcomed them
(C) No improvement
(D) when the captain had welcomed them

Q.24

Given below are four jumbled sentences. Out of the given options pick the one that gives their correct order. A. While he was doing this, he missed seeing a velvet purse full of gold coins lying on the road. B. Ramesh always worried about how he would become sick and weak in old age. C. To try how he would cope with blindness, Ramesh started walking with his eyes closed. D. He feared that he might even lose his sight and go blind.

(A) DBAC
(B) BDCA
(C) CABD
(D) BCAD

Q.25

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select No improvement. Mother was watching a movie when the lights “were going off.”

(A) No improvement
(B) went off
(C) have gone off
(D) going off

Answer key

General Awareness

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(C)**
Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(D)**
Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(A)**
Q.25 **(A)**					

English Comprehension

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(C)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(D)**
Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(B)**	Q.25 **(B)**

Explanations

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (D) Narmada

The Narmada forms the Dhuandhar Falls at Bhedaghat, near Jabalpur in Madhya Pradesh, as it enters its gorge of marble rocks.

Q.2 · Answer (A) ₹2 Lakh

Pradhan Mantri Jeevan Jyoti Bima Yojana, launched in 2015, is a one-year renewable term life cover of ₹2 lakh for death from any cause.

Q.3 · Answer (B) Teller

ATM stands for Automated Teller Machine: it does a bank teller's work, such as paying out cash.

Q.4 · Answer (C) Lipulekh - Uttarakhand

Lipulekh Pass, in Pithoragarh district of Uttarakhand, is on the route to Kailash Mansarovar. Bomdila is in Arunachal Pradesh, Nathu La in Sikkim and Rohtang in Himachal Pradesh.

Q.5 · Answer (C) cytology

Cytology is the study of cells; histology studies tissues, physiology the working of living things and taxonomy their classification.

Q.6 · Answer (B) 9th January

Pravasi Bharatiya Divas is marked on 9 January, the day in 1915 when Mahatma Gandhi returned to India from South Africa.

Q.7 · Answer (C) Manipur

Bangladesh borders West Bengal, Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram. Manipur borders Myanmar, not Bangladesh.

Q.8 · Answer (C) Hockey

Vece Paes, Leander Paes's father, played hockey for India and won a bronze medal at the 1972 Munich Olympics.

Q.9 · Answer (B) Mahabalipuram

The Dharmaraja Ratha is one of the Pancha Rathas, monolithic rock-cut temples carved under the Pallavas in the 7th century at Mahabalipuram (Mamallapuram), Tamil Nadu.

Q.10 · Answer (D) Ammonium

A cation is a positively charged ion. Ammonium (NH_4^+) is positive; fluoride, chloride and iodide are negative ions, anions.

Q.11 · Answer (A) Atal Tunnel

On 25 December 2019, Atal Bihari Vajpayee's birth anniversary, the government named the tunnel under the Rohtang Pass the Atal Tunnel.

Q.12 · Answer (C) Padayani – Kerala

Padayani is a ritual masked dance of the Bhagavati temples of central Kerala. Thang Ta is a martial art of Manipur, Dalkhai a folk dance of Odisha and Kalbelia a dance of Rajasthan.

Q.13 · Answer (B) Ashta Pradhan

Shivaji's council of eight ministers was the Ashta Pradhan. The Navaratnas were the nine gems of Akbar's court, and the Ashta Diggajas the eight poets of Krishnadevaraya's court.

Q.14 · Answer (D) Kalpa

Of the six Vedangas, Kalpa deals with ritual; Shiksha is phonetics, Vyakarana grammar and Chhanda metre (the other two are Nirukta, etymology, and Jyotisha, astronomy).

Q.15 · Answer (D) dioptre
The power of a lens, P = 1/f with f in metres, is measured in dioptres. A lens of –2.0 D is a concave (diverging) lens of focal length 0.5 m.

Q.16 · Answer (B) Calcutta
The special session at Calcutta in September 1920, presided over by Lala Lajpat Rai, adopted Gandhi's programme of Non-Cooperation; the regular session at Nagpur in December 1920 confirmed it.

Q.17 · Answer (D) Sudha Murthy
'Wise and Otherwise: A Salute to Life' is a collection of real-life stories by Sudha Murty.

Q.18 · Answer (D) Rumtek
Rumtek Monastery, near Gangtok, is in Sikkim. Tabo and Kye (Key) are in Spiti, Himachal Pradesh, and Hemis is in Ladakh.

Q.19 · Answer (A) Canada balsam
Canada balsam has a refractive index of about 1.53, very close to crown glass's 1.52, which is why it is used to cement lenses. Ruby and sapphire are about 1.77 and diamond 2.42.

Q.20 · Answer (B) Articles 25-28
Articles 25 to 28 guarantee the Right to Freedom of Religion. Articles 14-18 cover the Right to Equality, 19-22 the Right to Freedom and 23-24 the Right against Exploitation.

Q.21 · Answer (D) 1951
The Constitution (First Amendment) Act was passed in 1951; among other changes it added the Ninth Schedule.

Q.22 · Answer (A) architecture
The Pritzker Architecture Prize, founded in 1979, is given each year to a living architect and is often called the Nobel Prize of architecture.

Q.23 · Answer (B) K Srikanth
Former India captain K Srikkanth received the Col. C.K. Nayudu Lifetime Achievement Award at the BCCI awards in Mumbai on 12 January 2020, which honoured the 2018-19 season.

Q.24 · Answer (A) P.V. Sindhu
SSC's key gives P.V. Sindhu: in September 2019 Visa signed her, then the world badminton champion, to Team Visa for the Tokyo 2020 Olympics, and press reports named her its brand ambassador.

Q.25 · Answer (A) Mercury
Mercury is a metal, liquid at room temperature, and conducts electricity. Ebonite, glass and dry paper are insulators.

English Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (B) Accross
The correct spelling is 'across'.

Q.2 · Answer (B) To consider someone inferior
To 'look down upon' someone is to regard them as inferior.

Q.3 · Answer (C) Holy
'Sacred' means connected with God or religion and worthy of reverence: 'holy'.

Q.4 · Answer (A) Draw
A game that ends with neither side winning is a 'draw'.

Q.5 · Answer (B) The National Anthem was sung with great enthusiasm by the children.
The simple past 'sang' becomes 'was sung' in the passive: 'The National Anthem was sung with great enthusiasm by the children.'

Q.6 · Answer (D) Foreign
'Native' means belonging to a place by birth; its opposite is 'foreign'.

Q.7 · Answer (B) opportunity
Advertising gives companies an 'opportunity', a chance, to sell their goods better than their competitors.

Q.8 · Answer (A) products
Companies sell their 'products': the goods and services the passage begins with.

Q.9 · Answer (B) on
A television is turned on with 'switch on'.

Q.10 · Answer (C) being
The product is being acted upon as we watch, so the passive '-ing' form is needed: 'some product or the other being pushed towards us'.

Q.11 · Answer (A) motive
The 'motive' behind advertising is its purpose: to increase sales and earn more profit.

Q.12 · Answer (C) The traveller asked the passerby if he could kindly help him find his way.
A yes-no question is reported with 'if', 'can' becomes 'could', 'me' and 'my' become 'him' and 'his', and 'please' becomes 'kindly'.

Q.13 · Answer (A) with a rich heiress
'Marry' takes a direct object: 'He married a rich heiress last year', without 'with'.

Q.14 · Answer (B) Exhausted
'Weary' means very tired: 'exhausted'.

Q.15 · Answer (B) are being honoured
With the article only once, 'the famous author and actor' is one person, so the verb is singular: 'is being honoured'.

Q.16 · Answer (C) Attractive
'Repulsive' means causing disgust; its opposite is 'attractive'. 'Hideous' and 'revolting' are close to synonyms.

Q.17 · Answer (A) benevolence
'Benevolence' is kindness and goodwill, which would make her loved; 'malevolence' and 'insolence' would not, and 'condolence' is sympathy at a death.

Q.18 · Answer (D) Keep oneself updated
To 'keep abreast of' something is to keep oneself informed of the latest developments in it.

Q.19 · Answer (A) assurance
An 'assurance' is a firm promise that something will be done; 'insurance' is cover against loss.

Q.20 · Answer (C) DACB
D introduces whales' maternal instincts, A describes the mother lifting the newborn calf to the surface, C adds that another whale often helps her, and B says how long the young stay with their parents: DACB.

Q.21 · Answer (B) Insatiable
'Insatiable' means impossible to satisfy.

Q.23 · Answer (C) No improvement
'Scarcely had ...' is followed by 'when', with the simple past for the second action: the sentence is correct as it stands.

Q.24 · Answer (B) BDCA
B gives Ramesh's worry about old age, D his fear of blindness, C how he tried walking with his eyes closed, and A what he missed while doing this: BDCA.

Q.25 · Answer (B) went off

A longer action in the past continuous is interrupted by a sudden one in the simple past: 'when the lights went off'.

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